# The Cold Outreach Script

One email does almost all of the work. Keep it short, ask for time and not a job, send it from your school address, and replace every bracket before you hit send. The specific detail in the second sentence is the whole email — it is the only line that proves you did work nobody asked you to do.

> **THE RULES OF THE SEND**
>
> Fifteen minutes, never more. Name a real desk and a real deal. Never attach a resume to a first cold email. Send Tuesday through Thursday, early morning. One bump five to seven days later on the same thread, then stop — a third email costs you the relationship.

## The Script

> **THE COLD OUTREACH EMAIL · BANKER, DEAL-SPECIFIC**
>
> *Subject: [School] [year] — 15 minutes on [Desk]?*
>
> Hi [Name],
>
> I’m a [year] at [School] recruiting for investment banking. I came across your work on the [Desk] team and the recent [Deal], particularly [specific detail about the financing structure, valuation, or strategic rationale].
>
> I’d appreciate 15 minutes to learn more about your experience at [Bank]. Would you be open to a quick coffee chat sometime next week?
>
> Best,
> [Name]

*Read it out loud before you send it. If any sentence could have been sent to a different banker at a different bank without changing a word, that sentence is doing nothing for you.*

# Filling the Brackets

Six brackets. Five are research; one is the email. Write the detail line first and build the rest around it.

| Bracket | What goes in it |
|---|---|
| **[Name]** | First name only. No “Mr.,” no “Dear.” Confirm the spelling against LinkedIn, not the alumni directory. |
| **[year] · [School]** | “sophomore at Michigan,” not “student.” Your class year tells them which recruiting cycle you are in, which tells them whether to reply. |
| **[Desk]** | The group, not the bank: “Industrials,” “Leveraged Finance,” “Healthcare M&A.” A desk-level email gets read; a bank-level email gets deleted. |
| **[Deal]** | A named, announced transaction their group ran in the last twelve months. Press release or league table — never a rumor. |
| **[specific detail]** | One clause on structure, valuation, or rationale: the financing mix, the multiple relative to comps, why the buyer wanted it. This is the line that earns the fifteen minutes. |
| **[Bank]** | Their bank, spelled the way the bank spells it. Getting this wrong ends the thread on the spot. |

## The Bump

**SEND 5–7 DAYS LATER · SAME THREAD, NEVER A NEW ONE**

*Subject: Re: [School] [year] — 15 minutes on [Desk]?*

Hi [Name] — following up briefly in case this got buried. Still would value 15 minutes whenever it’s convenient; if now is a bad stretch, I’m happy to reach back out after [month]. Thanks either way.

Best,
[Name]

*Log every send: name, desk, date out, date bumped, outcome. Review it once a week for ten minutes. The failure mode is never forgetting a banker — it is letting a reply sit unanswered for four days.*

**The detail in sentence two is the entire email.**

Take the 60-second quiz and get a personalized outreach list built around your target desks.

**TAKE THE QUIZ → wallstalpha.com/apply**

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